全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 33 單元 | 教育與學校 · Education & School

The Boy Who Hated Cram School

討厭補習班的男孩

When Jason entered senior high school as a freshman, his mother enrolled him in a cram school near Taipei Main Station. Three nights a week, after eight hours in his own classroom, he sat through another lecture on math or English. His academic record was average, and his mother believed that a tutor could change that. Jason believed something else: that he was wasting his life.

The cram school's discipline was strict. Every student had to register at the door, and an absence meant a phone call home. The teacher assigned pages from a thick workbook every night and instructed students to memorize fifty words before each quiz. Jason copied, memorized, and forgot. His comprehension did not improve, and his essays stayed short and dull.

Everything changed when a new adviser, Mr. Kao, joined the center. Instead of lecturing, he asked Jason what he actually wanted to learn. Jason, surprised, said he liked building model planes. Mr. Kao brought in an English reference book about flight and told Jason to read one page a day and write three questions about it. For the first time, Jason wanted to look up words. The words he learned for the quiz began to appear in his reading, and his revision at home no longer felt like punishment.

By the end of the year, Jason had moved from the intermediate class to the advanced one. He later graduated with a certificate of excellence in English, which the headmaster handed him at graduation in front of the whole school. Years later, as a scholar at a university in Hsinchu, he still remembered Mr. Kao's guidance: "A learner who asks questions will always go further than one who only memorizes answers."

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句

cram	*v.*	填鴨式死記；(cram school) 補習班	Many students cram for exams the night before. 許多學生在考試前一晚臨時抱佛腳死背。
enroll	*v.*	註冊；報名	She enrolled in a summer art course. 她報名了一門暑期美術課程。
tutor	*n.*	家教；導師	My tutor comes to our house every Tuesday. 我的家教每週二都來我們家。
academic	*adj.*	學業的；學術的	The school is proud of its academic results. 這所學校以它的學業成績為榮。
memorize	*v.*	記住；背誦	It took me an hour to memorize the poem. 我花了一小時把這首詩背起來。
discipline	*n.*	紀律	Good discipline is important in a large class. 在大班級裡，良好的紀律很重要。
guidance	*n.*	指導；引導	With her teacher's guidance, she chose the right major. 在老師的指導下，她選擇了合適的科系。
graduate	*v.*	畢業	My brother will graduate from university next June. 我哥哥明年六月將從大學畢業。
lecture	*n.*	講課；演講	The professor's lecture on history lasted two hours. 教授的歷史課講了兩個小時。
freshman	*n.*	（高中或大學）一年級新生	As a freshman, he did not know anyone at school. 身為新生，他在學校誰都不認識。

片語 Phrases

sit through	耐著性子聽完（坐到結束）	We had to sit through a three-hour meeting. 我們必須耐著性子坐完三小時的會議。
look up	查閱（字典、資料）	Look up the word if you do not know it. 如果你不認識這個字，就查一下。
for the first time	第一次	For the first time, she enjoyed reading in English. 她第一次享受用英文閱讀。

文法與句型 Grammar

By＋過去時間, S＋had＋p.p.（過去完成式）

表示在過去某個時間點之前已經完成的動作。文中 By the end of the year, Jason had moved from ... 表示「到年底時，Jason 已經升班了」。

By the time the bell rang, we had finished the test.

鐘響時，我們已經寫完考卷了。

Instead of＋V-ing, S＋V

「不是做……，而是……」。instead of 後面接動名詞或名詞。文中 Instead of lecturing, he asked Jason ... 表示高老師不講課，反而問問題。

Instead of watching TV, he read a book.

他沒有看電視，而是看書。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。